Eric S. Wang

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Education

University of Washington, Ph. D.: Economics **2022 –**

- **Fields:** Urban and Spatial Economics, Public Economics, Development Economics

Yale University, B.A.: Economics and Sociology Double Major **2018**

- **Coursework:** Statistics, network analysis, Chinese.

Job Market Paper

"The Spatial Incidence of Affordable Housing" with *Yvonne Ng*

How should policymakers design affordable housing policy? Facing challenges in affordability and supply, many cities have turned to inclusionary zoning (IZ) policies, offering subsidies to encourage the integration of income-restricted units into market-rate developments. We study a long-running IZ program in Seattle, showing these policies change where housing is built and affect the neighborhoods they are built in. Although program requirements are uniform, differences in local conditions change developer responses. We document a trade-off: in higher-income neighborhoods, rent discounts for subsidized units are larger, but developer participation is more limited. Using granular rental data and spatial difference-in-differences, we further show that IZ lowers rents in lower-income areas but raises them in higher-income areas, consistent with increased competition in the former and building-driven amenity changes in the latter. To interpret these patterns, we build a quantitative urban model with developer choice and rationed affordable housing, showing how policy design and implementation choices can significantly distort policy effects. Affordable housing programs may expand access to high-quality housing for lower-income residents but may also contribute to gentrification in wealthier areas, resulting in mixed welfare effects.

- Presented to Seattle Office of Housing as "MFTE Evaluation Final Report"
- News Coverage: Seattle Times, The Urbanist
- Presentations: WEAI 2025, AREUEA 2026, APPAM 2026 (accepted)
- Rachel M. Storer Award for the best paper in labor economics (UW)

Research Publications

- "Parenting Centers and Caregiver Mental Health: Evidence from a Large-scale Randomized Controlled Trial in China." Qi Jiang, Sarah-Eve Dill, Sean Sylvia, Manpreet K. Singh, Xinshu She, Eric Wang, Alexis Medina, and Scott Rozelle. *Child Development*, 93, 1559-1573. https://doi.org/10.1111/cdev.13782

Work in Progress

- "Flat or Flats? The effect of Up-zoning on Informality and Child Mortality in Delhi" with *Tynan Challenor, Sahil Gandhi, and Vaidehi Tandel*
  - Presentations: Northwest Development Workshop 2026
- "Homelessness Spillovers" with *Zack Almquist*
- "Finding Signal in the Noise: Measurement of Mobile Phone and Mobile Internet Access" with *Seth Garz*
  - Presentations: Oxford Digital Technologies and Sustainable Development Workshop 2024

Prior Research Employment

Research Assistant to Profs. Jason Kerwin and Rebecca Thornton, Northern Uganda Literacy Project, University of Washington and University of Notre Dame	2024-
Research Assistant to Seth Garz, Bill and Melinda Gates Foundation	2023
Pre-doctoral Research Assistant to Prof. Martha Bailey, UCLA	2021 – 2022
Pre-doctoral Research Assistant to Profs. Scott Rozelle and Hongbin Li, King Center on Global Development, Stanford University	2019 – 2020
Summer Internship to Prof. Nicholas Christakis, Yale Institute for Network Science	2018
Herb Scarf Research Fellow, Prof. Ivana Katic, Yale University	2017-2018

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant, University of Washington **2022 – Pres.**

- ECON 509 Macroeconomic Analysis III (First-year graduate core)
- ECON 491 Issues in Economic Development
- ECON 411 Behavioral Economics

Independent Instructor, University of Washington

- ECON 301 Intermediate Macroeconomics
- ECON 201 Introduction to Macroeconomics
- ECON 200 Introduction to Microeconomics

Director of Development, New Haven Urban Debate League **2015 – 2018**

Other Details

- **Workshops:** 2018 Yale-CUHK Workshop "Making Sense of Urbanizing China",
- **Technical:** Stata, R, Matlab, ArcGIS **Languages:** Mandarin Chinese.

References

Jason Kerwin (co-chair)
Associate Professor of Economics
University of Washington
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Brian Greaney (co-chair)
Senior Research Economist
Federal Reserve Bank of Dallas
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Rachel Heath
Alberta C. Corkery Professor of Economics
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Gregg Colburn
Marsha and Jay Glazer Endowed University Professor of Real Estate
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colburn3@uw.edu